

Puffins can fly at about 55 mph (88 kph) and swim underwater for up to one minute.



Puffins

Reykjavik

ICELAND

In the spring, several male hares chase a female, who may turn around and box them with her front feet!

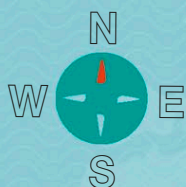


Mountain hare

Predators hunt many of these small rodents, but their numbers grow quickly. Females can have young every 3 to 4 weeks, all year round!



Norway lemming



SWEDEN

A superb climber, the lynx often hides in trees and then drops down onto an unsuspecting deer.



Eurasian lynx

This bat has shaggy brown fur with blond tips. It is the only bat found north of the Arctic Circle.



Northern bat



Boreal owl

The boreal owl has such good hearing that it can pinpoint voles hidden beneath the snow.

Oslo

Helsinki

Stockholm

Tallinn

ESTONIA

Riga

LATVIA

LITHUANIA

BELARUS

Gotland
BALTIC SEA

Northern European taiga

Taiga is the evergreen forest that grows in cool, wet, mountainous places in the far north of the world. Mammals need thick, furry coats, and birds need to fluff up their feathers to keep warm. During the cold winters, food can be hard to find.